

This type of syntax is used when the source workbook (the workbook that contains the data you want to use) is open. In this example, the name of the source workbook is “Sales.xlsx”, the worksheet which contains the data is “Annual” (note the “!” after the worksheet name), and the range where the data lies is cell B23 to B49.

When the source workbook file is not open, then the reference includes the full path to where the workbook is stored, as so:

```
=SUM('D:\Div1\[Sales.xlsx]Annual!B23:B49)
```

What will make tasks simpler, however, is the use of defined names. Simply refer to the source workbook and the named range you want to total. For example:

```
=SUM(Sales.xlsx!SalesDiv1)
```

Alternatively, if the source workbook does not have defined names, you can create your own defined name in your main workbook. Open both the source and main workbooks. Click Define Names in the Formulas tab, select “Define Name...”, and in the resulting pop-up box, give a name for the selection you are about to make. Clear the “Refers to” box and ensure that the cursor is blinking in this box. Then switch to your source workbook and select the range or cells you want to include, and click OK. You can then use this named reference in your main workbook as you would with any other reference.

You can also control how and when the external links are updated. If the source and main workbooks are open, any changes in the source workbook will be automatically reflected in the main workbook. If, for example, the main workbook is closed and the data is changed in the source workbook, then when the main workbook is opened, a security alert will pop up informing you, “Automatic update of links has been disabled”. To enable it, click the Options button and select “Enable this content”. As a security